

2023



BGL Employs Artificial Intelligence to Help Customers Save Over 130,000 Hours in Document Processing Time Using AWS

Discover how an Australia-based software business innovated using AWS AI/ML services to build a new automated paper to data solution, increasing revenue with worldwide reach.

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More than 130,000 man-hours

Time saved cumulatively for document processing



Hi, I can connect you with an AWS representative or answer questions you have on AWS.



Up to 75%

Quicker turnaround time for document processing



Need more info? Highlight any text to get an explanation generated with AWS generative AI.



2

80%

Volume of document processing work automated

6x

Increase in the volume of files processed

Overview

Financial investment data processing is time-consuming yet critical. Paper documents such as bank statements, invoices, receipts, and other documents contain data relevant to the compliance process. Today, much of this data is manually extracted from documents, interpreted, and then collated for regulatory filing.

Identifying the challenge customers faced, Australia-based software company [BGL](#) developed software solutions to remove the manual process and improve turnaround time. In 2020, BGL built BGL SmartDocs, a cloud-based software solution. Powered by artificial intelligence (AI), the software automates the process of data extraction, categorization, and interpretation as part of the financial investment reporting procedures. Using BGL SmartDocs, accountants and advisors can automate over 80 percent of their document processing work, significantly reducing manual data entry and improving data accuracy.

BGL serves over 9,500 businesses across 15 countries including Australia, Hong Kong, New Zealand, and Singapore. With BGL SmartDocs fully deployed on AWS, the company can confidently scale its applications to accommodate high traffic volumes and client workloads without disruptions or downtime.



The illustration features a central laptop displaying the SmartDocs360 web application. The interface includes a sidebar with navigation options like 'Business Models', 'Word Annotations', 'Labels', 'File Attributes', 'Workflow Status', 'File Created', and 'File Updated'. The main content area shows a table with columns for 'Filename' and 'Labels', listing various sample PDF files. Surrounding the laptop are several icons representing key features: a cloud upload icon, a document icon, a smartphone with a document overlay, a gear with a circular arrow for automation, a document with a clock for scheduling, a padlock for security, and a robot head for AI. A 'Secure Storage' badge with a padlock icon is prominently displayed. The bottom right corner features the 'SmartDocs360 powered by bgl' logo.

Opportunity | Automating Manual Processes and Mitigating Data Privacy Risks

Before BGL SmartDocs was developed, BGL's customers relied on manual data entry to extract and categorize documents for their financial investment reporting. In 2022, close to 26 million pages of documents were processed. This manual work incurred an estimated cost of US\$1.75 per page. It was complex to manage and took an average of 3 business days per client to complete.

BGL recognized an automated and secure document processing solution would remove the need for manual data entry and better handle Personally Identifiable Information (PII) in documents. This would significantly reduce the risk of a privacy breach.

Given the volume of data handled, BGL also required a robust and scalable way to deploy its solution in the cloud, as well as to support its users across multiple geographies.

Solution | Delivering Faster, Smarter and More Cost-Effective Document Processing Using AWS

BGL SmartDocs revolutionizes document processing, reducing costs by over 80 percent. The average processing time has also been reduced from 2 hours to 30 minutes – a 75 percent improvement.

By leveraging [Amazon Textract](#), an advanced machine learning (ML) service that automatically extracts printed text, handwriting, and data from any document, BGL SmartDocs now automates about 80 percent of processing work from scanned documents. This automated process has helped BGL customers save over 130,000 man-hours since the cloud-based software solution was released in 2020. The volume of processed files has also increased six-fold from 685,000 files in 2021 to 4,300,000 files in 2022.

BGL SmartDocs' backend uses [Amazon Elastic Kubernetes Service](#) (Amazon EKS), a managed Kubernetes service, to deploy its containerized applications without needing to install, operate, and maintain its own Kubernetes environment. The company also leverages [AWS Lambda](#), a serverless, event-driven compute service.



code and automate response requests at scale. Since AWS Lambda is also a fully managed service, BGL does not have to provision or manage the infrastructure to scale. Instead, its IT team can focus on maintaining the availability and compatibility of BGL SmartDocs across the various markets it serves.

In 2022, BGL enhanced its capabilities with [Amazon SageMaker](#), an ML service, to create a developer edition of BGL SmartDocs 360. Amazon SageMaker builds, trains, and deploys ML models for any use case. BGL SmartDocs 360 – Developer, allows developers to build customized document extraction and classification solutions to meet their business needs by training their own AI models with just a few mouse clicks

Outcome | Innovating with Cloud-based Solutions to Drive Growth and Expansion

BGL SmartDocs is a cost-effective and efficient document processing solution that has spurred customer growth. From 93,000 entities in 2022, the software has grown to support nearly 200,000 in 2023 - a 109 percent increase. BGL plans to provide this service beyond Australia to a worldwide audience.

BGL is also set to unveil a BGL SmartDocs 360 – Retail in October 2023, targeting users across the general accounting market.

“With AWS, we now have the scalability we need to address customer demands and grow our business in new markets all in a secure, cost-effective package. Amazon SageMaker in particular, has been instrumental in the creation of BGL SmartDocs 360 – Developer, which will create a brand-new revenue stream for us,” said Daniel Tramontana, Chief Executive Officer of BGL.

About BGL

With over 30 years of experience in the software industry, BGL Corporate Solutions (BGL) delivers innovative, multi-award winning company compliance management, self-managed superannuation fund (SMSF) and investment solutions to over 9,500 businesses in Australia, Hong Kong, New Zealand, Singapore, the United Kingdom, and 15 other countries around the world. BGL clients include all major accounting firms, law firms, many listed and private company groups, accountants, financial planners, and many individual SMSF trusts.

AWS Services Used

Amazon Textract

Amazon Textract is a machine learning (ML) service that automatically extracts text, handwriting, layout elements, and data from scanned documents.

[Learn more »](#)



Amazon SageMaker

Amazon SageMaker is built on Amazon's two decades of experience developing real-world ML applications, including product recommendations, personalization, intelligent shopping, robotics, and voice-assisted devices.

[Learn more »](#)

Amazon EKS

Amazon Elastic Kubernetes Service (Amazon EKS) is a managed Kubernetes service to run Kubernetes in the AWS cloud and on-premises data centers.

[Learn more »](#)

AWS Lambda

AWS Lambda is a serverless, event-driven compute service that lets you run code for virtually any type of application or backend service without provisioning or managing servers.

[Learn more »](#)

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AWS Inclusion, Diversity & Equity

What Is DevOps?

What Is a Container?

What Is a Data Lake?

What is Artificial Intelligence (AI)?

What is Generative AI?

What is Machine Learning (ML)?

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